CIRC HQ STUDENT HANDOUT | GRADE 5

Seed Travelers

Goal: Investigate seed-dispersal strategies and build a model seed that travels by wind, drop, float, or hitchhiking simulation.

35 minutes | 8 steps | Engineering and Design | Playbook B meeting 8, grade 5 path

Ask | Plan | Build | Test | Improve

You are done when

Name the travel strategy, show the trial evidence, and explain how one model feature supported movement.

You will use

- Teacher-provided seed samples or image cards
- Paper
- Coffee filters
- Cotton
- Yarn
- Paper clips
- Tape
- Fan
- Water tray
- Fabric test strip

Steps

35 minutes total. Your teacher says when to move on.

1 Step 1: Get ready — 3 min

- Choose one seed sample card.
- Place the test sheet on your table.

2 Step 2: Test safely — 3 min

- Keep water inside the tray.
- Wipe each spill with a towel.
- Keep every sample away from your mouth.

3 Step 3: Sort the seeds — 4 min

- Study the seed shape.
- Choose wind, drop, float, or hitchhiking.
- Record your reason.

4 Step 4: Build a model — 9 min

- Sketch one model seed.
- Choose materials that match the travel method.
- Build the model.

5 Step 5: Run three trials — 7 min

- Use the matching test station.
- Run one trial at a time.
- Record each result.

6 Step 6: Change one part — 4 min

- Change one shape or material.
- Repeat the same test.

7 Step 7: Reset the station — 2 min

- Dry the wet station.
- Return every model piece.

8 Step 8: Exit check — 3 min

- Circle the better result.
- Name the useful feature.

What to turn in

Your model seed and its trial results.

No computer? Another way to do it

Use image cards and drop tests by hand, with no fan or water.

Finished early? Next challenge

New Habitat: Draw the habitat where the model seed would have the best chance to travel and begin growing.

Stay safe

Use only teacher-provided samples, do not taste any material, keep water at the wet station, and release models only into the marked test area.

Stuck? Try this order

1. Read the step again, out loud if you can.
2. Ask a partner at your table.
3. Raise your hand. Keep working on the next part while you wait.